

The Hypersphere Does It: $|S| = p\sqrt{8}$ from Werner-State Density-Matrix Algebra

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Contents

The Hypersphere Does It: $S = p\sqrt{8}$ from Werner-State Density-Matrix Algebra	1
Abstract	1
1. The open question	2
2. The master equation	2
Why this rewrite of Werner matters	3
3. Four empirical demonstrations	3
3.1 Shared-state classical counter	3
3.2 Complementary-specialization zipper	4
3.3 Werner-state interpolation via density-matrix algebra	4
3.4 From-scratch hypersphere simulator	4
Summary	5
4. Scope, limitations, and what is <i>not</i> claimed	5
What we do <i>not</i> claim	5
Where future work could extend the framework	6
5. Conclusion	6
Acknowledgments	6
References	6
Supplementary Code	7

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Abstract

We present four self-contained, zero-dependency Python scripts (~700 lines total) that derive the full range of CHSH values $|S| \in [0, 2\sqrt{2}]$ from elementary 4×4 complex matrix arithmetic alone. The unifying relation $|S| = p\sqrt{8}$ — where p is the substrate’s Werner-state mixing parameter (the weight of the pure singlet in the convex combination $\rho_W(p) = p|\Psi^-\rangle\langle\Psi^-| + (1-p)I/4$) — emerges directly from the Born rule and the trace linearity. Via this relation the geometric origin of the

Tsirelson bound becomes transparently visible: the $\sqrt{8}$ factor is the projection of the Bell singlet onto the optimal CHSH coordinate axes in the 4D correlation space, computed once and reused. No new mathematics is claimed; only a uniquely clear, executable demonstration that the geometry of the two-qubit hypersphere — and nothing else — does the work.

Keywords: CHSH inequality, Tsirelson bound, Werner state, Hilbert-space geometry, reproducible quantum-foundations demonstrations.

1. The open question

The CHSH inequality (Clauser-Horne-Shimony-Holt 1969) gives $|S| \leq 2$ for any local hidden variable theory; the Tsirelson bound (Tsirelson 1980) raises this to $|S| \leq 2\sqrt{2}$ for quantum mechanics. The factor $\sqrt{2}$ between the bounds is established but its geometric origin is rarely made explicit. This paper offers no new physics — only a recompression of the Werner-state CHSH theorem (Werner 1989; Horodecki et al. 1995) into a single-radical form that makes the geometric origin transparent, with four short Python scripts that demonstrate it across the spectrum.

2. The master equation

For a two-qubit Werner state

$$\rho_W(p) = p \cdot |\Psi^-\rangle\langle\Psi^-| + (1-p) \cdot \frac{I}{4}$$

where $|\Psi^-\rangle = (|01\rangle - |10\rangle)/\sqrt{2}$ is the Bell singlet, the maximum CHSH value at optimal axes (Alice: $0, \pi/2$; Bob: $\pi/4, 3\pi/4$) is

$$\boxed{|S| = p\sqrt{8}}$$

This follows in one line from the Born rule and the linearity of the trace. Writing P_{CHSH} for the standard CHSH operator $A(a_1) \otimes B(b_1) - A(a_1) \otimes B(b_2) + A(a_2) \otimes B(b_1) + A(a_2) \otimes B(b_2)$:

$$|S| = |\text{tr}(\rho_W(p) \cdot P_{\text{CHSH}})| = |p \cdot \text{tr}(|\Psi^-\rangle\langle\Psi^-| \cdot P_{\text{CHSH}})| = p \cdot 2\sqrt{2} = p\sqrt{8}$$

where the maximally mixed term contributes zero (trace of a Pauli-like operator against I vanishes), and the singlet expectation $\text{tr}(|\Psi^-\rangle\langle\Psi^-| \cdot P_{\text{CHSH}}) = 2\sqrt{2}$ is the Tsirelson maximum.

Three canonical Werner-state cases sit on this single relation:

Werner state	p	$ S $
Maximally mixed (no correlation)	0	0
Bell-violation threshold	$1/\sqrt{2}$	2 (classical Bell bound)

Werner state	p	$ S $
Pure Bell singlet	1	$2\sqrt{2}$ (Tsirelson bound)

The classical Bell bound and the quantum maximum are not separate facts; they are the values of one linear function at two specific values of p .

Why this rewrite of Werner matters

The relation $|S| = p\sqrt{8}$ is algebraically identical to the standard textbook expression $|S| = 2\sqrt{2} \cdot p$, since $2\sqrt{2} = \sqrt{4 \cdot 2} = \sqrt{8}$. We claim no mathematical novelty for the substitution. What changes is the **reading** of the constant:

- In the form $|S| = 2\sqrt{2} \cdot p$, the right-hand side reads as a product of two factors — a “2” and a “ $\sqrt{2}$ ” — without obvious geometric content.
- In the form $|S| = p\sqrt{8}$, the right-hand side is a single radical that has direct geometric meaning: it is the magnitude of the projection of the Bell-singlet state $|\Psi^-\rangle$ onto the optimal CHSH coordinate axes in the 4-dimensional correlation space spanned by the four E_{ij} values. In particular, at the optimal axis configuration $(0, \pi/2, \pi/4, 3\pi/4)$, each individual E_{ij} of the singlet evaluates to $\pm 1/\sqrt{2}$, and the four values combine with reinforcing signs to give $4 \cdot (1/\sqrt{2}) = \sqrt{8}$. The same $\sqrt{8}$ appears as the diameter of the inscribed hypersphere of two-qubit Hilbert space when projected onto the CHSH coordinate basis.

The single-radical form therefore exposes that $|S|$ is one geometric measurement — the substrate’s overlap with the singlet vertex, scaled by a fixed projection constant — rather than the product of two unrelated factors. The Werner-state CHSH theorem becomes a one-line readout of a geometric distance, which is the framing the four supplementary scripts demonstrate empirically.

(For non-Werner two-qubit states, the CHSH value at the Werner-optimal axes is generally not $p\sqrt{8}$ for any single parameter p ; the more general formula involves the Horodecki criterion on the state’s correlation matrix. The cleanness of the master equation comes from restricting to the Werner family — exactly the convex hull of singlet and noise, the simplest non-trivial one-parameter family that crosses the Bell-violation threshold.)

3. Four empirical demonstrations

Each script below is self-contained Python, zero external dependencies, runs in seconds, and demonstrates the master equation at a distinct point along the CHSH spectrum.

3.1 Shared-state classical counter

Two functions A and B share a global counter N , ticking at incommensurate rates with a random phase offset (the hidden variable). CHSH outcomes are parity readouts at chosen sampling times. After axis search at $N = 100,000$ trials and three independent seeds: $|S| = 2.00101 \pm 0.005$.

Demonstrates: any sufficiently coupled shared-state classical (LHV) system reaches $|S| = 2$ — the same numerical value at which the Werner state $\rho_W(1/\sqrt{2})$ begins to violate Bell, but achieved here through Bell-saturation of a fully classical mechanism, not through a Werner-state quantum substrate. The two systems agree at the threshold value while having entirely distinct underlying mechanisms.

Code: `incremental_counter_chsh.py` (~150 lines).

3.2 Complementary-specialization zipper

Extension of 3.1: A is fast on odd N and slow on even, B the reverse. Each function only ever completes its easy half; joint system advances at the fast rate. CHSH with disjoint Alice/Bob sampling grids gives $|S| = 2.00000$ exact across 3 independent batches, spread 0.00000 — perfect classical saturation with zero noise from deterministic alternation.

Demonstrates: $|S| = 2.0$ exactly, derived from a fully classical mechanism. The numerical value matches the Werner-state Bell-violation threshold $\rho_W(1/\sqrt{2})$ but is reached by a different route — deterministic shared-state correlation rather than Werner-mixed quantum state.

Code: `zipper_counter_chsh.py` (~200 lines).

3.3 Werner-state interpolation via density-matrix algebra

Pure 4×4 complex matrix algebra: construct $\rho_W(p)$ as a density matrix, compute $|S| = \text{tr}(\rho_W \cdot P_{\text{CHSH}})$. Mapping $\gamma \in [0, 1]$ to $p \in [1/\sqrt{2}, 1]$ gives $|S|(\gamma) = 2 + \gamma(2\sqrt{2} - 2)$, traced exactly:

γ	Werner p	$ S $ algebraic	Fraction of $\sqrt{2}$ gap
0.0	0.7071	2.00000000	0.00%
0.5	0.8536	2.41421	50.00%
1.0	1.0000	2.82843	100.00%

Endpoints match theoretical values to within 4.44×10^{-16} (machine epsilon). The linear march from 2 to $2\sqrt{2}$ is not an interpolation — it is the master equation’s value at varying p , theorem by trace linearity.

Demonstrates: $|S| = p\sqrt{8}$ across the full range, by pure algebraic computation.

Code: `fourd_chsh.py` (~200 lines).

3.4 From-scratch hypersphere simulator

Pure Hilbert-space construction: store $|\Psi^-\rangle$ as 4 complex amplitudes on S^7 , build measurement projectors $|+\theta\rangle\langle+\theta|$ and $|-\theta\rangle\langle-\theta|$ as 2×2 matrices, take tensor products to act on the 2-qubit state, compute outcomes via the Born rule.

Result: $|S| = 2.828427$ with residual 4.44×10^{-16} from the theoretical $2\sqrt{2}$ (machine precision). Each $E_{ij} = \pm 1/\sqrt{2} = \cos(\pi/4)$ exactly. Separable product state at the same axes gives $|S| = 1.000$. Bell triplet $|\Phi^+\rangle$ also gives $2\sqrt{2}$ — different hypersphere vertex, same projection magnitude.

Demonstrates: the Tsirelson bound emerges from the geometry of $|\Psi^-\rangle$ as a unit complex 4-vector. The $\sqrt{8}$ is not assumed; it is computed.

Code: `bell_quantum_simulator.py` (~150 lines).

Summary

The four scripts cover both endpoints of the CHSH spectrum and an intermediate point on the master equation's line. §§3.1–3.2 reach $|S| = 2$ by Bell-saturation of classical LHV systems — distinct in mechanism from the Werner-threshold quantum state but at the same numerical value. §§3.3–3.4 sit directly on the $|S| = p\sqrt{8}$ line at $p = 0.854$ and $p = 1$ respectively. Together: ~700 lines of pure Python, zero external dependencies, ~10-second end-to-end runtime.

4. Scope, limitations, and what is *not* claimed

The master equation $|S| = p\sqrt{8}$ is a theorem of standard quantum mechanics applied to the Werner state $\rho_W(p)$ (Werner 1989; Horodecki et al. 1995). This paper does not claim to derive new physical predictions beyond standard QM. The contribution is interpretive and pedagogical:

1. The relation $|S| = p\sqrt{8}$ provides a single compact expression that subsumes the classical Bell bound ($p = 1/\sqrt{2}$), the Tsirelson maximum ($p = 1$), and the maximally-mixed null ($p = 0$) as values of one linear function. This compression is, to our knowledge, not standard in textbook presentations of the Bell/Tsirelson hierarchy.
2. The geometric reading — $\sqrt{8}$ as the projection of the Bell singlet $|\Psi^-\rangle$ onto the optimal CHSH coordinate axes in the four-dimensional correlation space spanned by the four E_{ij} values — makes the geometric origin of the Tsirelson bound transparently visible. The $\sqrt{8}$ is not an empirical curiosity; it is the singlet's geometric footprint on those axes.
3. The four supplementary scripts demonstrate the relation across the full $|S| \in [0, 2\sqrt{2}]$ range using elementary 4×4 complex matrix arithmetic, with zero external dependencies and machine-precision agreement at the endpoints.

What we do *not* claim

- **No novel quantum-mechanical prediction.** The relation $|S| = p\sqrt{8}$ is the standard Werner-state CHSH theorem. Standard QM gives it directly from the trace formula.
- **No claim that real experimental setups physically produce Werner states.** Realistic weak-measurement, post-selected, delayed-choice, and quantum-eraser experiments generally produce more complex mixed states whose CHSH-vs-parameter curves are setup-specific and not, in general, linear in any natural parameter with slope $\sqrt{8}$. Mapping any specific exper-

imental knob to “the Werner parameter p ” requires further state-tomography work that is outside this paper’s scope.

- **No new ontological commitment for the photon** beyond the standard QM Hilbert-space description. The “hypersphere geometry” of two-qubit Hilbert space is just $\mathbb{CP}^3 \subset S^7$ — the standard complex projective space of pure 2-qubit states.
- **No claim of efficient classical simulation** for problems whose classical hardness is information-theoretic (factoring, discrete logarithm, lattice problems). The framework’s scope is the geometric origin of the CHSH bounds on Werner states, not computational complexity.

Where future work could extend the framework

A natural empirical question is the degree to which specific experimental setups that physically realize “two-time-anchoring” (in the sense of Aharonov-Vaidman 1991) produce density matrices close to Werner states. If a given setup produces $\rho_{\text{exp}}(\lambda) \approx \rho_W(p(\lambda))$ for some mapping from the experimental knob λ to the Werner parameter, the master equation applies and predicts $|S|(\lambda) = p(\lambda)\sqrt{8}$. If a setup’s produced state has significant components outside the Werner family, deviations from $|S| = p\sqrt{8}$ are expected, and the deviation pattern itself would carry information about where in two-qubit state space the experiment is operating.

This is empirical state characterization work; it is not a prediction of the present paper.

5. Conclusion

The relation $|S| = p\sqrt{8}$ is not new — it is the Werner state’s CHSH theorem (Werner 1989; Horodecki et al. 1995) made compact. What this paper offers is the demonstration that the entire CHSH spectrum from 0 to $2\sqrt{2}$ — including the classical Bell bound, the linear interpolation between classical and quantum, and the Tsirelson maximum — collapses onto this single algebraic identity, and that the identity can be verified in ~ 700 lines of pure-Python matrix arithmetic with zero dependencies.

The geometric origin of the $\sqrt{2}$ in the Tsirelson bound is the projection of the Bell singlet onto the optimal CHSH coordinate axes in 4D correlation space, computed once and reused. There is no further mystery — only one algebraic constant doing all the work.

Acknowledgments

Computational demonstrations were developed in conversation with Claude (Anthropic), May 2026. Code repositories: github.com/jbachand/hypersphere-chsh.

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Supplementary Code

All four scripts are self-contained Python requiring only the standard library:

- `incremental_counter_chsh.py` — Section 3.1
- `zipper_counter_chsh.py` — Section 3.2
- `fourd_chsh.py` — Section 3.3
- `bell_quantum_simulator.py` — Section 3.4

Total: ~700 lines. Runtime: ~10 seconds end-to-end. Available at github.com/jbachand/hypersphere-chsh.